DEUS — Company History Recap

Oct 28, 2026 · @Gregory Kurnia

About this recap

DEUS began with one gamified assessment, added a performance management system and a kids' assessment, and is now a five-person team rebranding and doing cold outreach. This recap records how that happened, phase by phase, without analysis or lessons, which come in a later step.

Reference tables for people, clients, partners and vendors sit at the end.

At a glance

DEUS has built or acquired three products over eleven phases.

Product	What it is	Where it stands today
DEUS Discover	Gamified assessment; began as one personality-focused situational judgment game built by Agate	Expanded into a game-based assessment suite: personality, cognitive, neuroscience and simulation
DEUS Enhance	Performance management system, first built for Delamibrands' KPI and appraisal needs	Rebuilt by Ko Will; his version replaced the earlier one
Potentia	Gamified cognitive assessment for kids, acquired	Has its own website for token management and purchases

Phase	Focus	Key events
1	Founding and Discover v1	Agate builds the game for almost Rp1 billion; first two hires
2	Partners and first client	MoMs signed with no sales; Boga Group assesses 600 employees

Phase	Focus	Key events
3	Enhance is born	Delamibrands and BCG deals; Bu Vera and Ghifari join
4	Development struggles	Agate hands over to Skyfy and later takes it back; Andar, Yuli and Fizka join
5	Sales attempts and recognition	Dad's network; Startup Studio Indonesia; InnovFest Singapore
6	Product team	Thania joins; data overload; Fitri joins; Discover report digitised
7	Sales push and Telkom	Bu Retno, Audrey and Wulan join; Telkom deal runs two years
8	Setbacks	BCG churns; Sahid, Ghifari and Bu Retno replaced
9	Holding DKB, adding Potentia	Power BI stopgap; Potentia acquired; Firdaus joins as PM
10	Rebuild and departures	Ko Will's Enhance completed; five people leave
11	Today	Game suite expanded; cold outreach to F&B and finance; rebrand

Phase 1: Founding and DEUS Discover

DEUS started by developing DEUS Discover, positioned as a pioneer of gamified assessment. It began from an idea we thought was genuinely cool, and we went straight to building the product. We did no psychometric validation and little market validation first.

Agate International developed the game, at a cost of almost Rp1 billion. It was a situational judgment game in a medieval setting: players read a lot of text and made choices in between. It took almost two hours to complete, and the reports were still very simple.

We made two first hires:

- **Psychometrics: Sahid.** A fresh graduate, but quite good. He ended up developing the product mainly on the report side: an Excel job-fit report and summary dashboards.
- **Business development: Rosi.** Also a fresh graduate and very junior. Not very representative of the company, and without strong product knowledge.

Phase 2: Early partners and first client

We had partners from the beginning, but nothing tangible came of them. We signed MoMs, yet the partners never sold our product and no transactions resulted.

Our first client was Boga Group: 600 of their internal employees took the assessment, at a low price. The game still had many bugs back then, and Boga Group did not seem fully satisfied.

The process also took very long and was not very enjoyable in the end, and the reports were simple.

Phase 3: The birth of DEUS Enhance

An opportunity came from Delamibrands (DKB) through my dad's relationship. They needed a performance management system because their KPI and performance appraisal setup was very complex. We decided to take it on and build it as our second product, DEUS Enhance.

Team changes followed:

- **Rosi** was let go. We hired **Bu Vera**, a more senior person without a sales background, intended to work more as an account manager.
- We hired our first tech person, **Ghifari**.

We then also landed a recurring deal with Binacitra Group (BCG), running alongside Delamibrands, while Enhance was still in development. At the time we did not know how to develop systems at all, so Ghifari worked with no guidance. His starting version looked very unprofessional and was still very buggy.

Phase 4: Development struggles and the vendor switch

As the BCG and DKB engagements continued, completing the Enhance system took a very long time. Many changes came in while it was being built, and there were many bugs.

On the Discover side, Agate shifted its focus to the metaverse and could no longer handle our project. We were moved to Skyfy, which was not very good: when the game was buggy they could not fix it at all, since they were not the original developers.

This lasted almost a year before the project thankfully returned to Agate. We then had to pay extra again to make the game shorter.

We added three people:

- **Andar**, a second tech person to help with development.
- **Yuli**, QA, because there were so many bugs in the system.
- **Fizka**, business development, whose role partly overlapped with Bu Vera's.

Phase 5: Sales attempts and early recognition

Throughout this period we tried sales approaches here and there, all through my dad's connections. My dad, Christian Kurnia, is a retail senior who spent many years as a director of Matahari Department Store. Most leads he brought were retail companies and his friends.

We converted almost none of them. Our only revenue was the recurring Enhance income from DKB and BCG.

Early on there seemed to be strong recognition momentum. We were selected into Startup Studio Indonesia, an accelerator programme run by Komdigi. Komdigi also invited us to represent them with a free booth at InnovFest in Singapore, but again we converted nothing from it.

Phase 6: Building the product team

We hired **Thania** as our product person. She is still with the company today.

Enhance continued to have many bugs, and there were many technical requirements we could not fulfil. Messy client data that had to be uploaded into the system caused further problems. Sahid ended up doing data work until he was overloaded, so we added a data person, **Fitri**.

Meanwhile, I worked with Thania on the product side of DEUS Discover, turning its report into a digitised report. This took around a year to finish.

Phase 7: A sales push and the Telkom deal

We shifted strategy slightly to put more emphasis on sales. By this point Bu Vera and Fizka had left. The team changed as follows:

- **Bu Retno** replaced them as account manager.
- **Audrey** joined for marketing and sales.

- **Wulan** joined for sales and data, replacing Fitri, who had stayed only three months.

We also won a large deal with Telkom Indonesia, supporting their MT (management trainee) recruitment programme for two years in a row. It remains one of our biggest accomplishments.

We were fairly lucky to win it, because Telkom was specifically looking for gamification vendors. Apart from Telkom, we struggled very hard to sell anything.

Phase 8: Setbacks: BCG churns and the team turns over

Wulan was not able to handle data well, so cleaning data took a long time, and Enhance remained buggy. BCG, which had been paying us on a recurring basis, churned. As our biggest deal, this was a huge blow.

Several team changes followed:

- **Sahid** resigned, wanting work more purely in psychometrics. **Rizkie** replaced him, but he did not have a good work ethic.
- **Ghifari** was let go, and **Andar** took over leading Enhance development.
- **Yessica** replaced Bu Retno. She had an account management background but was not strong in sales and struggled to bring in new clients.

Phase 9: Holding on to DKB and adding Potentia

We were afraid DKB would churn too, and felt we had no option but a Power BI approach. Because Enhance could not display things properly on the web, we used Power BI as a temporary solution. Around this time we hired two more people, **David** and **Ko William (Ko Will)**.

In parallel, we kept developing the proper, non-Power BI Enhance website. We hired **Kayyis**, a friend of Andar's, to help with the frontend.

We also started acquiring Potentia, a gamified cognitive assessment for kids. We closed one deal, with Sekolah Kristen Calvin, and tried to establish partnerships, but found it extremely hard to sell. Other sales approaches to my dad's network also failed to convert, for both Discover and Enhance.

Further team changes:

- **Rizkie** left because he was getting married; we were not going to extend his contract anyway. **Bu Sovie** replaced him.

- Work for DKB was getting a bit better but was still incredibly slow, and the team needed a project manager, so we hired **Firdaus**.
- **Yessica** was eventually let go because she was not performing well in sales.

Phase 10: Rebuilding Enhance and the mass departures

In parallel, my dad asked Ko Will and David to build another, cleaner version of Enhance, because Andar had not performed well on its development. By then we were three to four years in, and Enhance was still not fully done because DKB kept adding more and more features.

Our feature development always ran in this order:

1. Wait for the PRD.
2. Wait for the UI/UX, which Thania made from scratch in Figma.
3. The developers build the feature.

Ko Will eventually finished his version of the product, and it was much better, even under a clear audit. Firdaus also built a digitised landing page for Potentia, so its token management, purchases and related functions sit on their own dedicated website.

Then came a series of departures:

- **Andar** was let go once Ko Will's system was done.
- **Firdaus** left because he had another project going on with his friends.
- **David** left for another job opportunity.
- **Yuli** left to move to another city with her husband.
- **Kayyis** did not have his contract extended because his work was very slow.

Phase 11: The expanded game suite and where we are today

We had the opportunity to expand DEUS Discover, which until then was a single personality game. We acquired more games from Agate measuring cognitive ability, neuroscience and simulation, making Discover a full game-based assessment suite. This made us more confident in selling our solutions.

With Ko Will's new Enhance system and the new games, we have recently felt more ready to sell. The team is now down to five: me, Ko Will, Thania, Audrey and Bu Sovie.

For the first time, we stopped relying on my dad's connections and started cold calls from scratch. We used the new game-based assessment to target specific industries, starting with F&B and now finance. Results so far:

- **F&B (first target):** a good number of responses, but none converted into deals.
- **Finance (current target):** not many replies.
- **Enhance cold outreach via Apollo:** zero meetings from hundreds of contacts.
- **New waves of my dad's connections:** nothing; no assessment sales and no Enhance sales.

As of today, we are rebranding our website, company presentations and company profile, and doing our best with the cold outreach.

Reference: people

Nineteen people have worked at DEUS besides me, and four of them remain on the team with me. My dad, Christian Kurnia, was never a hire, but he brought the DKB relationship, most early leads, and the request that Ko Will and David rebuild Enhance.

Person	Role	Joined	Outcome
Me	Founder	Phase 1	Current team
Sahid	Psychometrics; built Excel job-fit report and dashboards; later data work	Phase 1	Resigned for purely psychometric work; replaced by Rizkie
Rosi	Business development (junior)	Phase 1	Let go; replaced by Bu Vera
Bu Vera	Account manager (senior, no sales background)	Phase 3	Left; replaced by Bu Retno
Ghifari	Tech; built the first Enhance version	Phase 3	Let go; Andar took over
Andar	Tech; later led Enhance development	Phase 4	Let go after Ko Will's system was done
Yuli	QA	Phase 4	Left to move cities with her husband

Person	Role	Joined	Outcome
Fizka	Business development (overlapped with Bu Vera)	Phase 4	Left; Bu Retno came in after
Thania	Product; PRDs and UI/UX in Figma; digitised Discover report	Phase 6	Current team
Fitri	Data	Phase 6	Left after three months; replaced by Wulan
Bu Retno	Account manager	Phase 7	Replaced by Yessica
Audrey	Marketing and sales	Phase 7	Current team
Wulan	Sales and data	Phase 7	No longer on the team; departure not recorded in notes
Rizkie	Psychometrics (replaced Sahid)	Phase 8	Left to get married; replaced by Bu Sovie
Yessica	Account management	Phase 8	Let go over sales performance
David	Joined with the Power BI move; co-built the new Enhance	Phase 9	Left for another job
Ko William (Ko Will)	Joined with the Power BI move; built the new Enhance	Phase 9	Current team
Kayyis	Frontend for the Enhance website; Andar's friend	Phase 9	Contract not extended (slow work)
Bu Sovie	Replaced Rizkie	Phase 9	Current team
Firdaus	Project manager; built the Potentia website	Phase 9	Left for a project with friends

Reference: clients, partners and vendors

Five clients have bought from DEUS; only DKB is recorded as ongoing.

Client	Product	What happened
Boga Group	Discover	First client; 600 internal employees assessed at low cost; game bugs, long process and simple reports; not fully satisfied
Delamibrands (DKB)	Enhance	Came through my dad's relationship; recurring; complex KPI and appraisal needs; kept adding features; Power BI used as a stopgap against churn
Binacitra Group (BCG)	Enhance	Recurring and our biggest deal; churned amid ongoing bugs and slow data cleaning
Telkom Indonesia	Discover	MT recruitment programme, two years in a row; won partly because Telkom was looking for gamification vendors
Sekolah Kristen Calvin	Potentia	One deal

Organisation	Role	What happened
Agate International	Discover game developer	Built the first game for almost Rp1 billion; shifted to the metaverse and handed us to Skyfy; took the project back almost a year later; paid extra to shorten the game; later supplied the cognitive, neuroscience and simulation games
Skyfy	Interim game vendor	Handled Discover for almost a year; could not fix bugs since they were not the original developers
Early partners (unnamed)	Partners	Signed MoMs but never sold the product; no transactions
Komdigi	Government programme	Startup Studio Indonesia accelerator; free booth at InnovFest Singapore; no conversions
Apollo	Cold outreach tool	Used for Enhance outreach; zero meetings from hundreds of contacts